in a positive direction. This is reflected in their agreed 2030 Roadmap, among others.

Connecting the two countries and peoples can be pursued through different avenues, including closer political contacts, deeper economic and financial exchanges, greater skills and education flows, stronger research and innovation partnerships, and, of course, by nurturing the living bridge. Underlying this exercise is how we look at the world and grapple with issues that both nations confront every day.

The UK is a very different polity in the aftermath of Brexit. And some of these changes are precisely those that can provide impetus to a more contemporary partnership. Greater national control has allowed the UK to contemplate an Enhanced Trade Partnership with India. An agreement on a migration and mobility partnership helps to match demand, demographics and talent. The UK's Integrated Review locates it as a Euro-Atlantic actor, but with an increasing stake in the Indo-Pacific. That makes a compelling argument for a stronger understanding with India.

From India's viewpoint, there are many UKs that we seek to engage simultaneously: the Global Britain, the Atlantic UK, the post-European one, the City of London, the diaspora one, the innovation and education UK, and, of course, the strategic one. The internal balance among them has clearly shifted as a result of Brexit and the global aspect is now much more at the forefront. While refreshing their ties, India and the UK cannot ignore the issues carried forward from their history. But their conversation in the future will necessarily be different. In the final analysis, the true test of a transition to a new era will be in the ability to work together both on issues of the Indian subcontinent and the larger global stage.

Russia: A Steady Partnership

The story with Russia (erstwhile USSR) has been very different. A power that was suspicious of the Indian national movement, often to the point of being downright hostile, developed increasing shared interests as post-Independence diplomacy took root. This picked up after 1953–54, especially once Pakistan joined US-led alliance systems. Many political parties in our country also viewed the USSR as a progressive force. For an India increasingly worried about the Western arming of its neighbour, the relationship was both an insurance policy and an active contributor to our